

How to use this book

The activities in this book are intended to give you ideas for fun and creative things to do with your baby. A happy baby flourishes with a happy parent, however, so we've also included a few ideas to make your life as a parent easier and more enjoyable.

You can either work through each chapter as your baby hits the appropriate month, or dip in and out of the book, picking activities according to you and your baby's mood and skill development. If you decide to dip in and out, make sure you look for ideas that suit your baby's particular developmental stage.

All babies develop at different rates, so you must be guided by what your baby enjoys. If her skills aren't developed enough for a particular activity, you should wait until she reaches the appropriate developmental stage. Stay with your baby throughout every activity, supervise her closely, and be especially vigilant around water.

Whatever activities you decide on each day, it is your active involvement in her play, enjoyment of your time together, and the warmth of your relationship that makes playtime special to your baby.

